PLANT PROTECTION

Plum Pox Virus Survey and Eradication Program

In September 1999, the Plum Pox Virus was found in an Adams County orchard. As a result, the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA), Penn State, and the Pennsylvania Department of Agriculture (PDA) teamed up to find, end, and prevent outbreaks of the virus.

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Overview

First discovered in North America in 1999, the Plum Pox Virus causes the most destructive disease of Prunus (a genus of trees and shrubs in the flowering plant family Rosaceae). The virus is more commonly called plum pox, PPV, or Sharka.

In October 1999, peach fruit showed symptoms of a disease and tests confirmed the causal agent of the disease.

The Pennsylvania Department of Agriculture announced that the virus was found in Adams County, PA.

Plum pox strains can affect a variety of fruits and nuts like:

- Peaches
- Plums
- Apricots
- Nectarines
- Almonds
- Cherries

It is possible for the virus to affect some Prunus and non-Prunus species. The strain of virus found in Pennsylvania is the D-strain.

Over 20 aphid species can spread the virus to healthy plants. It can also spread through infected nursery stock or grafting.

Plum Pox Virus

More commonly known as plum pox, PPV, or Sharka.

- Damage
- Distribution
- Hosts
- Symptoms
- Spread
- Diagnostic Tools
- Control

Additional resources

- Penn State Sharka/Plum Pox Virus
- Canadian Food Inspection Agency
- National Agricultural Pest Information System (NAPIS)
- USDA-APHIS-PPQ

Contact Information

For more information, email us.

Publications

The Pennsylvania Plum Pox Eradication Program, 1999–2009.

Learn more.

Legal Library

Rescission of Quarantine Orders and Programs Relating to Plum Pox Virus.

Explore the Legal Library.

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